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The structure of Kanuri society

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In the questionnaire material there is a slight drop in shame responses towards elder siblings (not significant statistically) and a significant drop in respect responses when the relationship is compared to ego's relations to parent's collaterals. The figures are given in the following Table. R - response; N-R - number of responses which were different per subject for that category.

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TABLE III Responses to Older Siblings and Parents' Collaterals (no difference between patri- and matri-kin)

	<u>Shame</u>		<u>Respect</u>		<u>Friendship</u>	
	R	N-R	R	N-R	R	N-R
older siblings	16	61	67	10	41	34
par. collaterals	21	67	86	2	16	72
sig. level			.01		.01	

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(The chi-square test was used here. For the theoretical validity of its use with small numbers see: Lewis, D. and Burke, C.J. [The Use and Misuse of the Chi-Square Test](#), in the Psychological Bulletin, 46, pp.433-489, 1949; and Snedecor, G.W., [Statistical Methods](#), p. 169, 1940.)

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The indication that b[unknown]rzum is regarded primarily as a norm governing the behaviour by a subordinate to a superior rather than as a descriptive term for the relationship is illustrated in the following table which compares ego's responses on either side of a junior-senior relationship. The Ol-Sis-Hu and Wi-Yo-Bro have a reciprocal joking relationship with one another. However, the junior in the situation must pay respect(nona), or give respect (b[unknown]rzum) to the senior, even though their traditionally formalized interaction  61 is one of reciprocal joking. The joking itself is related to the respect behaviour. The older or senior member (Ol-Sis-Hu) must always joke with the younger or junior (Wi-Yo-Bro) saying he will obtain either a spouse or a sexual partner for the latter. And this is an essential aspect of b[unknown]rzum; the senior must give something in return for the subservience he receives.

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